Algebraic Geometry

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Contents

0.1 Plan . . . 1
0.2 Resources . . . 1
0.3 Why scheme theory? . . . 1

1 Beyond varieties **3**
1.1 Summary of classical algebraic geometry . . . 3
1.2 Limitations . . . 4

Lecture 1

0.1 Plan

1. Basics of sheaves of topological spaces
2. Definitions of schemes and of morphisms
3. Properties of schemes (the algebraic geometry analogues of compactness)
4. Rapid introduction to the cohomology of sheaves

0.2 Resources

1. Course webpage - Google Dhruv
2. Books:
   - Hartshorne - Algebraic Geometry, Chapter 2 and $\varepsilon \times$Chapter 3
   - Vakil - Rising Sea, good online (free) alternative
   - Eisenbud-Harris - Geometry of schemes
3. Four examples sheets on webpage
4. SAGES - Look on Dhruv's webpage

0.3 Why scheme theory?

Moduli theory – It is better to study families of varieties than one at a time. Or better, all varieties of a given type at the same time.

Examples of moduli: The set of all lines in $\mathbb{P}^2$. A line in $\mathbb{P}^2$ is

$$\{aX_0 + bX_1 + cX_2 = 0\}$$

In particular, as lines are paramterised by the triple (a, b, c), we have a correspondence

$$\mathbb{P}^2_{\text{dual}} = \text{lines in } \mathbb{P}^2 \leftrightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$$

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The same logic applies for degree d hypersurface in $\mathbb{P}^n$, and we get

$$\text{degree } d \text{ hypersufaces in } \mathbb{P}^n \leftrightarrow \mathbb{P}^N$$

where $N = \binom{n+d}{d} - 1$. However, there is something wrong with this picture. Some polynomials are of the form

$$f = f_1^2 f_2$$

But in this case,

$$\mathbb{V}(f) = \mathbb{V}(f_1 f_2)$$

and $f_1 f_2$ is (in general) not of degree d.

A solution Take $U_d \subseteq \mathbb{P}^N$, where

$$[f] \in U_d \iff f \text{ has no repeated factors}$$

But U_d is not compact.

Output of scheme theory for a fixed projective space $\mathbb{P}^n$, we obtain a space

$$\text{subvarieties of } \mathbb{P}^n \leftrightarrow \mathrm{Var}(\mathbb{P}^n) \subsetneq \mathrm{Hilb}(\mathbb{P}^n) \leftrightarrow \text{ subschemes of } \mathbb{P}^n$$

where $\mathrm{Hilb}(\mathbb{P}^n)$ is the Hilbert scheme of $\mathbb{P}^n$, which is compact in the Euclidean topology. That is, the limit of varieties need not be a variety, but limits of schemes are always schemes.

In scheme theory,

$$\mathbb{V}(X_0 + X_1 + X_2) \text{ and } \mathbb{V}((X_0 + X_1 + X_2)^2)$$

are not isomorphic as schemes.

Weil conjectures Fix $f \in \mathbb{Z}[X_0, \dots, X_{n+1}]$ homogeneous. We have

$$X = \mathbb{V}(f) \subseteq \mathbb{P}^{n+1}_{\mathbb{C}}$$

We will assume that X is smooth. That is, X is a (complex) manifold. In particular, X is a compact topological space, and so we have numbers $b_0(X), \dots, b_{2n}(X)$ called the Betti numbers, where

$$b_i(X) = \mathrm{rank}(H_i(X, \mathbb{Z}))$$

In particular, we have the Euler characteristic $\chi(X)$.

On the other hand, fix a prime number p, and let

$$N_m = \text{number of solutions to } f \text{ in } \mathbb{F}_{p^m} = \left|X(\mathbb{F}_{p^m})\right|$$

Define the Weil ζ function

$$\zeta(X; t) = \exp\left(\sum_m \frac{N_m}{m} t^m\right)$$

Theorem 0.1 (Weil conjectures, Grothendieck).

1. $\zeta(X; t)$ is a rational function in t
2. Moreover,
$$\zeta(X; t) = \frac{P_0(t) P_2(t) \cdots P_{2n}(t)}{P_1(t) P_3(t) \cdots P_{2n-1}(t)}$$
where $\deg(P_i(t)) = b_i(X)$.

Upshot: The proof is (fundamentally) via scheme theory. We need a space $\mathfrak{X}$ which interpolates geometry over $\mathbb{C}$ and geometry over finite fields.

Lecture 2

1 Beyond varieties

1.1 Summary of classical algebraic geometry

Let $k = \overline{k}$ be an algebraically closed field. Define the *affine space*

$$\mathbb{A}_k^n = k^n$$

as a set.

An *affine variety* is a subset

$$V = \mathbb{V}(S) \subseteq \mathbb{A}_k^n$$

for some $S \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. Note that $\mathbb{V}(S) = \mathbb{V}(\langle S \rangle)$, where $\langle S \rangle$ is the ideal generated by S. By the Hilbert basis theorem, or equivalently, $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is Noetherian, $\langle S \rangle$ is generated by finitely many elements. Moreover,

$$\mathbb{V}(I) = \mathbb{V}\left(\sqrt{I}\right)$$

where I is the *radical* of I, given by

$$\sqrt{I} = \{f \mid f^m \in I \text{ for some } m \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

Given varieties $V \subseteq \mathbb{A}_k^n$, $W \subseteq \mathbb{A}_k^m$, a *morphism* $\varphi : V \to W$ is a function $V \to W$, such that if we write $\varphi = (f_1, \dots, f_m)$, each f_i is a restriction of a polynomial in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. An *isomorphism* $\varphi : V \to W$ is a morphism, such that $\psi : W \to V$ also a morphism, $\psi \circ \varphi = \mathrm{id}_V$, $\varphi \circ \psi = \mathrm{id}_W$.

The basic correspondence is

$$\frac{\text{affine varieties over } k}{\text{isomorphism}} \leftrightarrow \text{finitely generated } k\text{-algebras } A \text{ without nilpotent elements}$$

How? Given a variety V (representing an isomorphism class of such), then we can write $V = \mathbb{V}(I)$. Moreover, we can assume that I is a radical ideal. We map

$$V \mapsto \frac{k[x_1, \dots, x_n]}{I}$$

Conversely, if A is a finitely generated nilpotent-free k-algebra, then by definition,

$$A \cong \frac{k[y_1, \dots, y_n]}{J}$$

where J is a radical ideal.

Note that we need to check that both maps are well-defined.

> **Notation 1.1.** The algebra associated to V is (classically) denoted $k[V]$, and called the *coordinate ring of* V.

Compatibility of morphisms

Note that we have a correspondence

$$\{\text{morphisms } V \to W\} \leftrightarrow \{k\text{-algebra homomorphisms } k[W] \to k[V]\}$$

Zariski topology

Suppose $V = \mathbb{V}(I) \subseteq \mathbb{A}_k^n$ is an affine variety, with coordinate ring $k[V]$. The *Zariski topology* has closed sets

$$V \cap \mathbb{V}(S)$$

where $S \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$.

If $V \cong W$ as varieties, then the topological spaces with the Zariski topology are also homeomorphic.

Nullstellensatz

Fix a variety V, and let $k[V]$ be its coordinate ring. Given a point $p \in V$, we can produce a homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{ev}_p : k[V] &\to k \\ \mathrm{ev}_p(f) &= f(p) \end{aligned}$$

Moreover, ev_p is surjective, for example, by taking the constant functions. With this,

$$\mathfrak{m}_p = \ker(\mathrm{ev}_p) \trianglelefteq k[V]$$

is a maximal ideal. So we get a map

$$\{\text{points } p \in V\} \to \{\text{maximal ideals in } k[V]\}$$

Hilbert's Nullstellensatz $\implies$ the above map is a bijection.
Therefore, points of V and maximal ideals in $k[V]$ are "the same thing".

1.2 Limitations

What is an abstract variety?

That is, what is a topological space X, such that we have an open cover $\{U_i\}$, where each U_i is an affine variety, which is compatible on overlaps? For example, we have projective space $\mathbb{P}^n$.

> **Example 1.2** (non-algebraically closed fields)
> Take the ideal
> $$I = \left\langle x^2 + y^2 + 1 \right\rangle \trianglelefteq \mathbb{R}[x, y]$$
> Observe $\mathbb{V}(I) = \varnothing \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, but I is prime, so radical. Hence the Nullstellensatz fails in this case.

On what topological space is $R[x, y]/\left\langle x^2 + y^2 + 1 \right\rangle$ "naturally" the set of functions?

Or more generally, $\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z}[x]$ and so on.

> **Example 1.3** (why restrict to radical ideals, or nilpotent free algebras)
> Let $C = \mathbb{V}(y - x^2) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^2_k$, and $D = \mathbb{V}(y) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^2_k$. Then
> $$C \cap D = \mathbb{V}(x, y) = \{(0, 0)\}$$
> If we set $D_\delta = \mathbb{V}(y - \delta)$, then $C \cap D_\delta$ is two points, for all $\delta \neq 0$.

Index

affine variety, 3

coordinate ring, 3

isomorphism
    of affine varieties, 3

morphism
    of affine varieties, 3

radical, 3

Weil conjectures, 2

Zariski topology
    of affine varieties, 3